ERIC DECASPER

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EDUCATION

California Polytechnic State University | San Luis Obispo, CA **Expected December 2026**
B.S. Mechanical Engineering | GPA 3.37 | Dean's List (5 terms)
Relevant coursework: Controls I and II, Machine Learning in ME, Mechatronics, Mechanical Vibrations, Heat Transfer

SKILLS

CAD and analysis: SolidWorks, Onshape, Fusion 360, GD&T, DFM, FEA (ANSYS)
Fabrication: Mill and lathe, wire-EDM tooling, 3D printing (FDM, SLA, SLS)
Programming: Python, MATLAB, C++ (Teensy firmware), Java
Languages: English, Swiss German (conversational), French (conversational)

EXPERIENCE

Western Magnetics Company | South San Francisco, CA **June 2026 - August 2026**
Mechanical Engineering Intern

- Built the pneumatic vibration-damping fixture and worked on the dashboard for the end-of-line tester that grades every production motor for electrical imbalance, vibration and drag in a 45-second cycle; it ran 4,400+ cycles by August and became the baseline for the team's motor design studies.
- Designed servo-press shear tooling from tungsten carbide with resistive heaters to test magnet adhesives across a range of temperatures, validated to over 5,000 N of press force.
- Used the press to qualify an adhesive 2-3x stronger than the incumbent, cutting adhesion failures from over 70% to near zero, and set up an in-line bond-strength test that caught an under-cured batch before it shipped.
- Traced motor KV variation to magnet thickness and lamination tolerance stack-up, then built a Keyence measurement fixture for stators; the team used the data to adjust winding programs and bring KV back into range.
- Created tooling for several automated stations, including custom wire-EDM tooling owned from design through fabrication, and set up an outside machining partner with about a one-week turnaround on urgent tooling.
- Built the company's first drone platform for flight-testing its motors and collecting in-flight performance data.

Voliro AG | Zurich, Switzerland **July 2025 - December 2025**
Mechanical Engineering Intern

- Revived a drone spot-repair capability (surface prep and paint) that an earlier team had dropped at proof of concept: built the first flight-worthy prototype in one week, then owned mechanical design and testing of both payloads with MontiPower through flight tests. Voliro now sells it as a service.
- Took the wire-wheel sanding payload from a PLA prototype to CNC aluminum and PA12 parts.
- Designed and validated a cooling solution for a next-generation drone radio, building a 40°C environmental chamber to verify sustained operation at worst-case ambient temperature.
- Re-architected legacy payload assemblies in SolidWorks into modular, maintainable CAD structures.

PROJECTS

NDT Scanning Arm, Voliro-sponsored senior project | Cal Poly SLO **January 2026 - Present**

- Leading a 4-person team building a drone-mounted arm that sweeps an EMAT ultrasonic sensor across steel structures to find defects at height.
- Designed the two-link carbon fiber arm under a 1 kg limit, then built and programmed its control system: a Teensy 4.1 running inverse kinematics on two Dynamixel XM430 servos, the first Voliro payload with its own microcontroller.
- Bench-tested on real steel assets; now integrating it onto a Voliro drone for flight testing at Cal Poly.

Aerial Manipulation with Reinforcement Learning | Cal Poly SLO **September 2026 - Present**

- Training reinforcement-learning controllers in Isaac Lab toward a learned controller for the senior-project arm.

LEADERSHIP

FRC Team 670, Homestead High School | Mechanical Lead **August 2021 - June 2022**

- Led mechanical design and fabrication on mills, laser cutters, CNC routers and 3D printers.
- Added a custom vacuum and compressed-air system to a CNC router, giving the team its first in-house aluminum cutting; FIRST Quality Award and 2022 Cal Games champions.